Practical 6: Build the RetailPulse Customer Insights Dashboard

Related topic: Build a Dashboard for Customer Insights Visualization | Tool: IBM Cognos Analytics | Package: RetailPulse

Objective

Assemble a dashboard combining a summary card, trend chart, segment breakdown, and a shared filter widget for RetailPulse customer data.

Materials Required

IBM Cognos Analytics access, RetailPulse Customers data module.

Step-by-Step Procedure

#	Action performed	Observation
1	Selected **New > Dashboard**, chose a template and added the **RetailPulse Customers** data module as the source.	Dashboard canvas opened with the data module fields in the Selections pane.
2	Added a **Summary (KPI) widget** with Customer ID (count distinct) filtered to active customers for the period.	Card shows total active customers.
3	Added a **Line chart**: Month on the x-axis, New Customers and Returning Customers as two series.	Trend line for both series across Apr-Sep.
4	Added a **Column/Bar chart**: Loyalty Segment on the category axis, customer count as the measure.	Four segments: Bronze, Silver, Gold, Platinum.
5	Added a **Region filter** (Selection control) and set it to filter all widgets on the canvas.	Selecting North updates the card, line chart and bar chart together.
6	Resized and aligned widgets: KPI card and filter on top row, trend chart and segment chart below, then **Saved** as 'RetailPulse Customer Insights'.	No overlaps; clear visual hierarchy.

Output

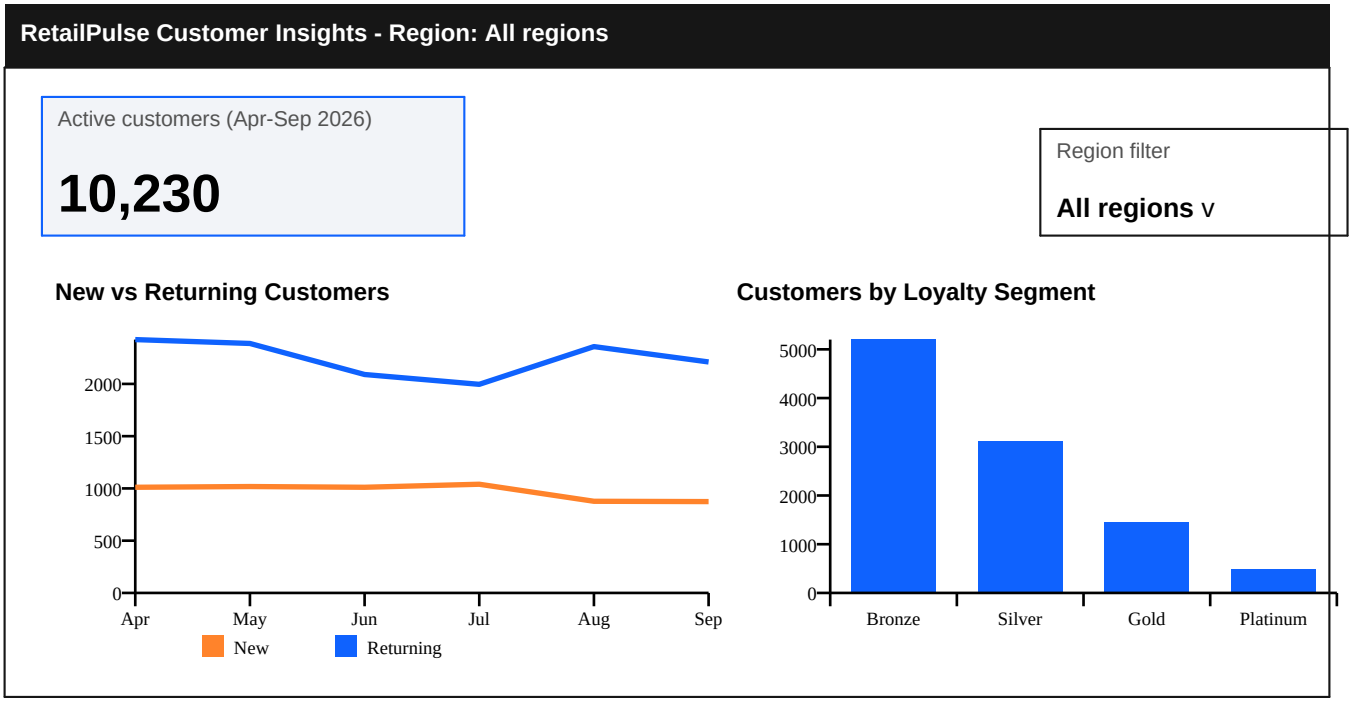

Fig 6.1: Dashboard before filtering. Active customers: 10,230.

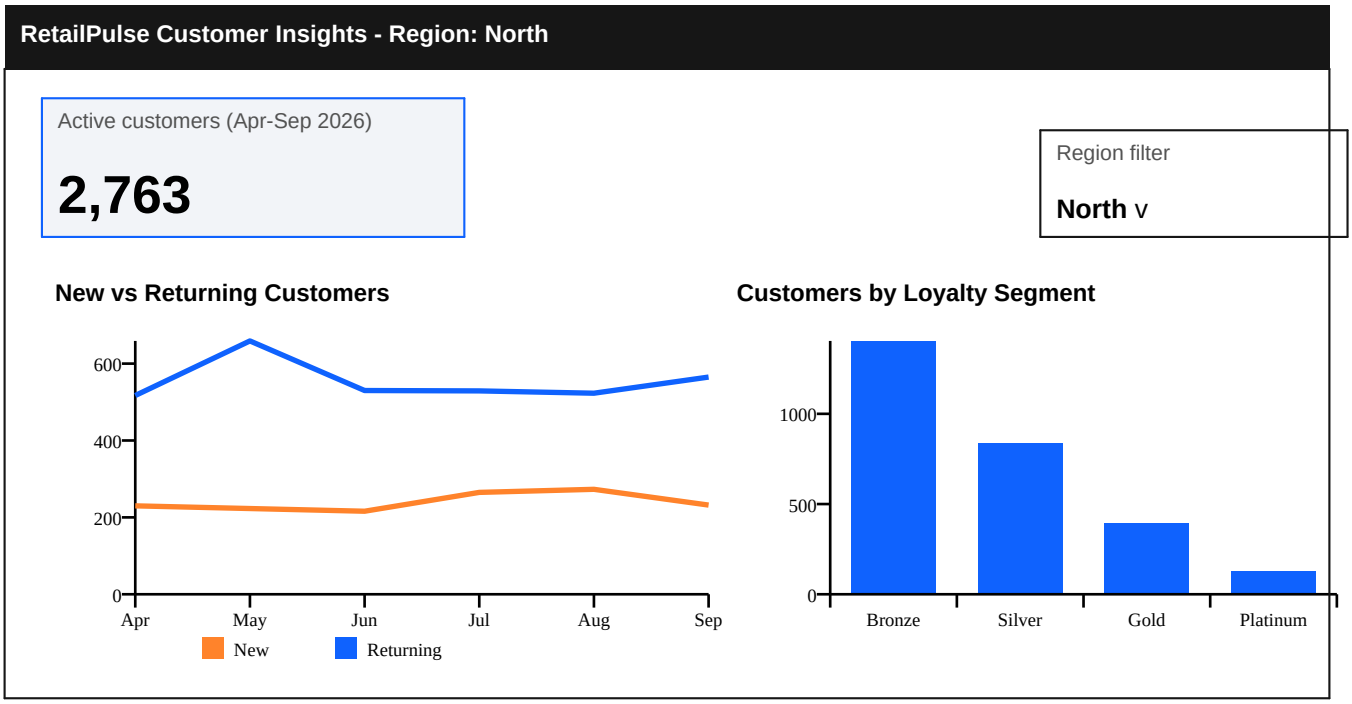

Fig 6.2: After selecting North in the filter widget, all three widgets update consistently (active customers: 2,763).

Expected Outcome Check

- ✓ All widgets display live data with no placeholder values.
- ✓ Region filter widget updates every other widget consistently.
- ✓ Trend line renders clearly across the full period.
- ✓ Layout follows a clear visual hierarchy with no overlaps.

Conclusion

A customer insights dashboard with a summary card, new-versus-returning trend line, loyalty-segment bar chart and a shared Region filter was built on the RetailPulse Customers data module.

Note: screens and figures are illustrative renderings built on a consistent sample RetailPulse dataset (report date 15 October 2026, current quarter Q4 2026: 1 Oct to 31 Dec).